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No Justice In Brooklyn

N.Y. KILLER COP ACQUITTED FOR MURDER OF BLACK TEEN

(New York, N.Y.) - Black people throughout New York are furious over last week's acquittal of White killer cop Michael Torsney, who maliciously shot a 15-year-old Black youth, Randolph Evans, in the head last Thanksgiving at point-blank range with absolutely no provocation.

Torsney was found not guilty by reason of insanity by an all-White jury which deliberated for less than five hours before reaching the stunning verdict.

At the conclusion of a 13-day trial in the state Supreme Court in Brooklyn, Justice Hyman Bashay ordered that Torsney be placed in an institution under the jurisdiction of the Mental Hygiene Department, where the murderer will undergo psychological testing.

After 60 days, Torsney can make an appeal for discharge if it is determined that he "is not a danger to himself or to the community," reports the *New York Times*. Legal experts feel that Torsney will be released shortly after the



Mrs. ANNIE BRANNON (shown with her husband) was stunned by last week's acquittal of a White N.Y. cop responsible for killing her son, Randolph Evans.

minimum 60-day period since he claimed that his disease had an organic cause — described by the defense as an epileptic seizure.

The 32-year-old White cop had no record of previous epileptic attacks but was known as a man who tended to panic.

During the trial, Dr. Herbert Spiegel, clinical professor of psychiatry at Columbia University, testified that Torsney suffered from hysterical dissociation — an emotional rather than an organic disorder — which does not fall under the category of legal insanity.

The verdict was bitterly received by friends and relatives of the slain Black youth, and by the Black community as a whole.

Just after the verdict was read, a spectator warned Torsney, "You'd better commit suicide."

A cousin of the victim, May Jones, commented, "I wasn't surprised by the justice that was done. He was justified in killing a Black youth. It's a racist system and society, and this trial was a subterfuge from beginning
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"Conspiracy Of Silence"

BIKO INQUEST VERDICT CLEARS POLICE

(Pretoria, South Africa) - Ignoring blatant evidence of perjured police testimony and gross medical incompetence, a South African

magistrate last week cleared the security police who murdered jailed Black Consciousness Movement (BCM) founder Steve Biko of any

wrongdoing.

As the predominantly Black crowd of spectators listened in silence, presiding magistrate Martinus J. Prins read a terse 120-word statement that blamed the fatal brain injuries sustained by the 30-year-old Biko as the result of a scuffle that police alleged he initiated on the morning of September 7 in a Port Elizabeth prison.

Biko died five days later in this city's central prison after having been driven while naked, shackled and in a comatose state in the back of a police van, 750 miles from Port Elizabeth.

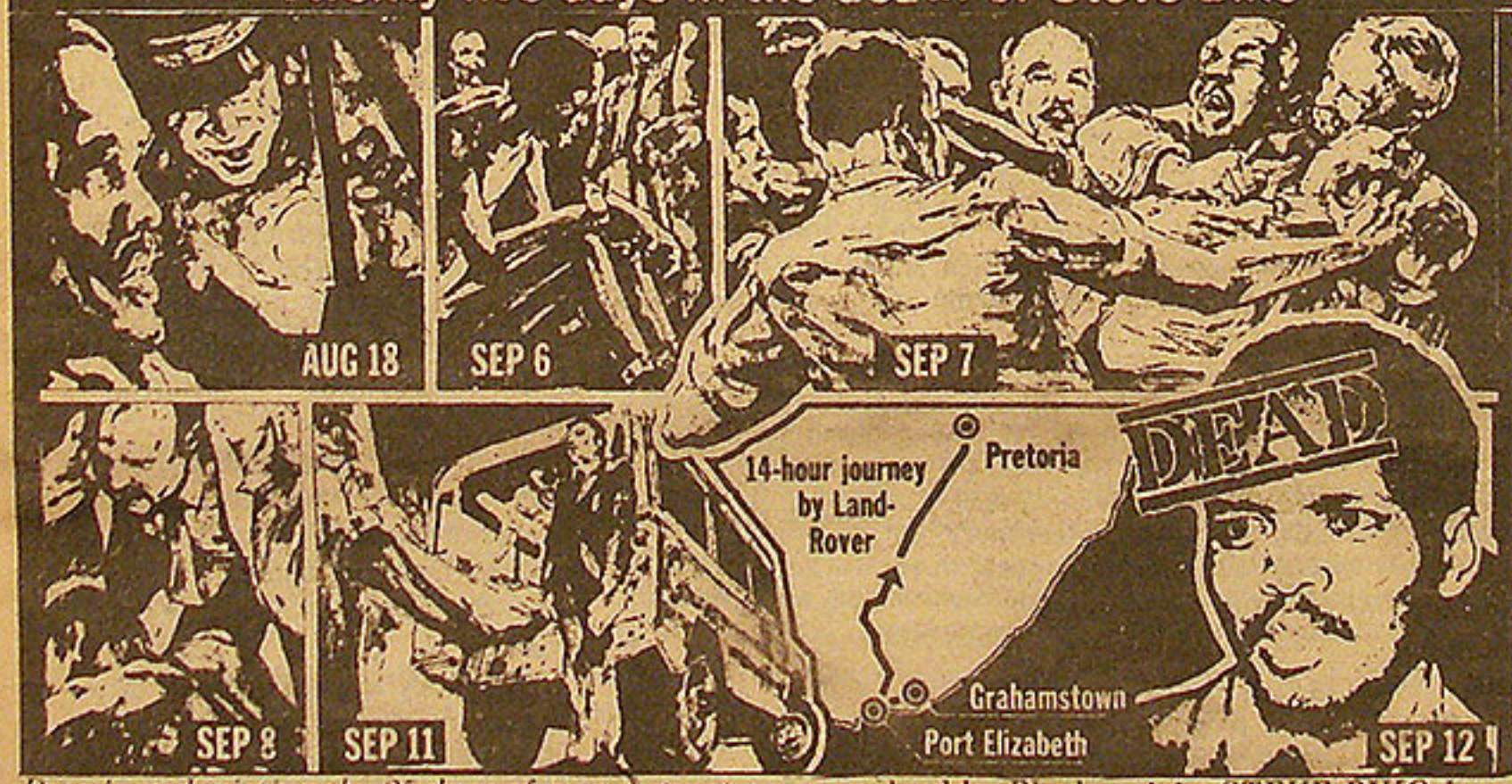
Taking less than three minutes to read his ruling whitewashing the South African government's murder of the much-respected Biko, Prins said:

"The available evidence does not prove that the death was brought about any act or omission involving or amounting to an offense on the part of any person."

Still dressed in black mourning clothes, Biko's widow Ntsiki, the only close member of the family present to hear the decision, said as she left the converted synagogue where the three-week inquest was held, "I'm just too depressed to say anything."

CONTINUED ON CENTERFOLD

Twenty-five days in the death of Steve Biko



Drawings depicting the 25 days of savage treatment received by Black activist STEVE BIKO from South African police from the time of his detention to his death on September 12. Biko was beaten into a coma and kept chained and naked before he succumbed to head injuries.

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